

TITLE:

On Caesar=0

AUTHORS:

Eric Johannesson

Anders E.V. Lundstedt

Frege found it problematic that his logicist project did not rule out the identification of Caesar with the number zero. Since the logicist project-together with its later reincarnations-must be given up on, the problem in its original formulation is no longer of interest. We nevertheless treat the question 'Is Caesar=0?'. We show the perhaps surprising result that it is perfectly consistent with our best scientific theories that Caesar=0. More generally, we show that any 'abstract object' may be identified with a space-time object; furthermore, the number of abstracts objects that may be simultaneously identified with space-time objects is equal to the cardinality of the set of space-time objects. Our findings are not only curiosities-for example, to some extent they may allow for a nominalistic theory of the world.